VARUN MALANI

Product Manager

+91-9538960097 • malanivarun@gmail.com • https://www.linkedin.com/in/varun-malani-330b16103/ • Bangalore

Summary

Product Manager with 8+ years of experience building and scaling SaaS products in ambiguous, execution-heavy environments. Strong focus on fixing broken user journeys, improving onboarding and activation and driving adoption through data-informed decisions. Experienced in 0→1 product development, enterprise onboarding and partnering closely with engineering, design and business teams to deliver measurable outcomes.

Experience

Smartstaff (Multiple Positions) — Bangalore, India

Product Manager — 04/2025 - Present

A company providing Blue-Collar Staffing and Workforce Management SaaS products.

- Owned the product roadmap for core workflows, prioritizing features to fix broken onboarding and configuration journeys and improve enterprise adoption.
- Diagnosed UX and workflow friction, built new wireframes and through A/B testing, led changes that increased feature adoption to 85%.
- Led 0→1 onboarding of 5 enterprise clients, partnering closely with engineering and design to build scalable setup and configuration systems.
- Reduced customer go-live timelines by 30% by simplifying product flows and removing process and system bottlenecks.
- Defined and tracked success metrics across adoption, usage and time-to-value, iterating post-launch based on data and customer feedback.

Program Manager — 04/2023 - 03/2025

- Playing a key role in strategic and product decisions, oversaw Payout, Compliance and Business Finance functions, leading a team of 8.
- Led cross-functional product programs focused on improving product adoption, delivery speed and operational scalability across BizOps and Fulfillment teams. Streamlined handoffs between product, engineering and operations teams.
- Designed and implemented scalable solutions to improve LTV (+15%) and reduce CAC (-10%). Built financial simulation frameworks to model and optimize P&L performance (+3% CM1).

Manager – Central Operations — 08/2022 - 03/2023

- Processed worker payouts of INR 50 Cr with 99% accuracy and latency, ensuring reliability at scale.
- Built and led a central ops team of 4 with available internal resources while steering through its 0→1 phase.
- Defined SOPs, KPIs and product-led solutions to eliminate operational leaks and improve user experience, driving margin growth of 5%.

Assistant Manager/Specialist - Customer Success — 10/2021 - 07/2022

- Managed end-to-end implementation for 35 B2B clients, driving adoption and retention during the product's early stage. Won 3 major clients, bringing in 60% of the subscription revenue.
- Co-created PRDs with the client/product teams for 3 major features, feeding structured user insights into roadmap planning.
- Mentored the Specialists in the team, establishing customer-centric delivery practices.

Gurpreet Enterprises — Bangalore, Karnataka

Entrepreneur — 01/2020 - 09/2021

A Family partnership focused on business development and client management.

- Streamlined Operations and Vendor Management, reducing costs by 4%.
- Added 5 new clients and one new product line to keep up revenue growth YoY at 10%.

Mazda Motor Europe GmbH — Cologne, Germany

Master Thesis Intern - Accessories Division — 05/2018 - 10/2018

A Japanese Automobile Manufacturer.

- Supported the Accessories Division and Pricing teams to identify new revenue opportunities in the European automotive after-market. Found an untapped €2M potential by market research and benchmarking. Developed a tailor-made solution through cross-functional collaboration across regions

Mazda Motor Europe GmbH — Cologne, Germany

Intern – Pricing and Analysis — 10/2017 - 03/2018

- Improved after market pricing through value-based pricing and benchmarking for over 400 parts.
- 12% revenue growth through price increase projects and competitive analysis while collaborating with the teams of the regional NSCs.

Experience

Saint-Gobain Performance Plastics
Bangalore, Karnataka

Application Engineer
07/2014 - 08/2016

A global leader in the design, manufacturing and distribution of high-performance materials.

- Responsibility of Design, Product, Pricing and Strategy for Automotive market.
- New segment breakthroughs and price revisions resulted in a 35% increase in revenue, 120% of the targets achieved YoY.
- Strengthened key relationships at Automotive OEMs and Tier-1s through timely RFI/RFQ proposals, technical and commercial feedback.
- Led coordination efforts across Asia, Europe and North America to collect regional intelligence and launch new products in key markets.

Key Achievements

Profit Margin Transformation at Smartstaff
Bumped up margins (CM) from -6% to +3% through policy and process optimizations.

0→1 Client Onboarding
Onboarded 5 enterprise clients in 4 months at Smartstaff's SaaS relaunch

Revenue Growth at Saint-Gobain
Converted 5 big ticket clients, adding 15% revenue growth for local and 5% for global businesses.

Revenue and Margin Enhancement at Mazda
Drove €300K revenue and margin lift through value-based pricing.

Client Acquisition at Gurpreet Enterprises
Increased revenue growth by 10% YoY in FY21 through client acquisition.

Skills

Core Skills: Product Strategy & Roadmapping · Growth & Retention Analysis · Cross-Functional Leadership · SaaS Operations

Technical: Google Suite · Metabase · Lovable AI · Microsoft 365 · Mixpanel · Freshdesk · Looker Studio · SQL Basics

Education

HTW Berlin
Berlin, Germany

Master's in Business Administration and Engineering
10/2016 - 09/2019

Visvesvaraya Technological University
Bangalore, Karnataka

Bachelor of Engineering - Mechanical
09/2010 - 06/2014

Certifications and Projects

Certifications

- Hybrid/Electric Vehicles and Renewable Energy from IIT-Madras with a score of 98/100

Projects

(Related to MBA&E Course)

- Scenario planning for 2032 for US OEMs based on industry trends
- Industry research and a strategic growth plan for Augmented Reality Technology in industrial and commercial application

Interests

Personal Interests
Astrophysics, Formula 1, Badminton.

Languages

English Native ●●●●●
Hindi Native ●●●●●
Kannada Proficient ●●●●○
German Beginner ●○○○○